

The First Amendment Bill to the Indian Constitution was presented in 1951 through which Articles 15, 19, 85, 87, 174, 176, 341, 342, 372, 376 were amended and two new Articles 31(a) and 31(b) and 9th Schedule was added to the Constitution.

4. Which of the following Constitutional Amendment Acts was termed as Mini Constitution?

- (a) 42nd (b) 44th
(c) 46th (d) 50th

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Several provisions of the Constitution were altered, and several new provisions were added by 42nd Constitutional Amendment in 1976. So it is also termed as mini Constitution. The main objective of 42nd Constitutional Amendment was to overcome the difficulties arising from the decision of the Supreme Court in Keshavananda Bharati Case 1973. The Supreme Court made it clear in its judgment that certain features of the Constitution are so essential that they cannot be abrogated from the Constitution of India.

Official Language

1. Which Article of the Indian Constitution prescribes Hindi in Devanagari script as the official language of the Union?

- (a) 341 (b) 342
(c) 343 (d) 346
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

Article 343(1) Part XVII of Indian Constitution is written that the official language of the union shall be Hindi in Devanagari Script. The form of numerals to be used for the official purposes of the union shall be the International form of Indian numerals.

2. The number of official languages recognised by the constitution in the eight schedule is.....

- (a) 16 (b) 17
(c) 18 (d) 20

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (*)

Before 92nd Constitution Amendment Act, 2003 there were total 18 languages in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution which increased to 22 after 92nd Constitution Amendment Act.

Panchayati Raj and Community Development

1. Which one of the following was established as the first programme of community development?

- (a) Cooperation Movement
(b) National Extension Service
(c) Integrated Rural Development Programme
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

The Community Development Programme (CDP) was the first major rural development programme launched after independence in 1952. Core objective of this program was to bring community development. The three phases of community development were National Extension Phase, Intensive Community Development Project Phase and Post-Intensive Development Phase. It is worth mentioning here that the National Extension Service program was formulated in April 1953 and it was inaugurated in October, 1953. It was formed after the Indian government realized that the Community Development Programme, which was formed in 1952, cannot be implemented all over India due to a shortage of funds.

2. The minimum age for contesting elections to the Panchayati Raj Institutions should be how many years according to the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act?

- (a) 18 years (b) 21 years
(c) 25 years (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Decentralization is the process in which Power is divided in many units. As for the local self government's structure in India, Panchayati Raj Institution is a system of local self-government in rural areas of the Indian subcontinent. Local Self-Government helps in the management of local affairs. It is important to mention here that such local bodies have representatives who have been elected by the local people and hence have a better understanding of grassroot level issues. Thus, the minimum age that a person should have for contesting elections is 21 years. The 73rd Amendment added Part IX to the constitution of India and was titled "The Panchayats". Furthermore, Part IXA of the constitution, titled "The Municipalities", was added by the 74th Amendment.

3. Panchayati Raj was first Introduced in–

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Uttar Pradesh
- (c) Himachal Pradesh
- (d) Rajasthan

43rd BPSC (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Article 40 of the Indian constitution directs states to constitute panchayats. In 1957, Balwant Rai Mehta committee recommended to establish three tier panchayat system. Based on its recommendation, Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru inaugurated Panchayati Raj in Nagaur district of Rajasthan on October 2, 1959 after that Andhra Pradesh also implemented this system and became the second state to implement Panchayati Raj system.

4. The decision to conduct Panchayat Elections is taken by which of the following?

- (a) The Central Government
- (b) The State Government
- (c) The District Judge
- (d) The Election Commission

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Panchayat is enumerated in State List as 5th entry in the 7th Schedule to the Constitution. It is the subject of State Government, and the State Government has the power to constitute it and conduct its elections.

5. The subject of Panchayati Raj is in –

- (a) Concurrent List
- (b) Union List
- (c) State List
- (d) Residual List

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Which one of the following functions is not the concern of Local Self- Government?

- (a) Public Health
- (b) Sanitation
- (c) Public Utility Services
- (d) Maintenance of Public Order
- (e) None of the above / more than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

Maintenance of Public Order is not the concern of Local Self Government. Public Health, Public Utility Services, Sanitation, Roads and Bridges, Developmental Schemes etc. are related to Local Self Government. Article 243(g) provides for powers, authority and responsibilities of Panchayats. Likewise Article 243W provides for powers, authority and responsibilities of Municipalities.

7. 73rd Amendment of the Constitution is related to -

- (a) Impeachment of the president
- (b) The appointment of the election commission
- (c) Reservation of seats in educational institutions
- (d) Panchayati Raj System

44th BPSC (Pre) 2001-02

Ans. (d)

Panchayati Raj Institutions were made constitutional by the 73rd constitutional Amendment Act, 1992.

8. The legislative origins of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act can be traced back to which Constitutional Amendment Bill?

- (a) 61st Constitutional Amendment Bill
- (b) 62nd Constitutional Amendment Bill
- (c) 63rd Constitutional Amendment Bill
- (d) 64th Constitutional Amendment Bill
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The 64th Amendment Bill was prepared in 1989 and introduced in Lok Sabha in July 1989, to confer constitutional status to Panchayati Raj Institutions. This was the first attempt by any government to do so after independence.

9. Which of the following was constituted under the Panchayati Raj system?

- (a) Khap Panchayat
- (b) Caste Panchayat
- (c) Gram Panchayat
- (d) Jan Panchayat
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Gram Panchayat consists of a village or a group of villages divided into smaller units called "Wards". Each ward selects or elects a representative who is known as the Panch or ward member. The members of the Gram Sabha elect the ward members through the direct election. The Sarpanch or the President of the Gram Panchayat is elected by the Ward members as per the state Act. The Sarpanch and the panch are elected for a year or five years.

10. Which Article of the Indian Constitution directs state Government to organize village Panchayats?

- (a) Article 32 (b) Article 40
- (c) Article 48 (d) Article 51

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Article 40 of the Constitution directs the States to constitute Gram Panchayats. It is included in the Directive Principles of State Policy. Article 40 provides that the State shall take steps to organize village Panchayats and endow them with such powers and authority as may be necessary to enable them to function as units of self-governance.

11. Panchayati Raj is organized as a unit of Self-Government under –

- (a) Fundamental Rights of Indian Constitution
- (b) The Preamble of the Indian Constitution
- (c) Directive Principles of State Policy
- (d) 73rd Amendment of the Indian Constitution

43th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The local self-government in India has been formulated under the Panchayati Raj System. 73rd Amendment of the Constitution 1992 gave it Constitutional status.

12. What is the main characteristic of Panchayati Raj System of Government?

- (a) It has three tiers of Government.
- (b) It aims to give social and economic justice to villages.
- (c) Some members of Parliament are as representatives in Zila Parishad.
- (d) All of these are true.

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (d)

Panchayati Raj is a system of local self-government with three tier system- Gram Panchayat at the village level, Panchayat Samiti at the block level and Zila Parishad at the district level. The Panchayati Raj System is aimed at achieving the goal of economic development and social justice.

13. To review the financial position of Panchayats, the State Government constitutes every five years a/an –

- (a) Finance commission (b) Finance committee
- (c) Advisory commission (d) Advisory committee
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

The state Government constitutes a finance commission every five years to review the financial condition of state panchayats. There is a provision for Constitution of finance commission under Article 243 (I) of the Constitution. Under this, the Finance Commission is constituted by the Governor.

14. What is the objective of community development?

- (a) Economic development
- (b) Build human capital
- (c) Environment protection
- (d) Harmonious life
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (e)

All around development of any community: For example - physical, social, moral and cultural development is called 'Community Development'. The main creator of community development in India S.K. Dey says, "Live and let live". This principle is the cornerstone of community development. It includes agriculture animal husbandry. Irrigation, co-operation, education, health, social production messaging, village industry, panchayat and all important elements of life. According to the United Nations. "Community Development Programme is the process by which the efforts of individuals to improve the economic, social and cultural conditions of communities, to include these communities to contribute to National progress". Efforts of government officials also get coordinated.

15. Panchayati Raj is mainly aimed at –

- (a) Increasing rivalry among villagers.
- (b) Giving training to villagers for contesting election.
- (c) Decentralization of power to villagers.
- (d) None of these.

43th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

The principal aim of Panchayati Raj System is the democratic decentralization of power to villages and to empower them to make policies according to their need and to implement these policies.

16. For successful functioning, Panchayati Raj needs full co-operation of-

- (a) Local Public (b) Central Government
- (c) Bureaucrats (d) Politicians

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Full cooperation of local public is required for Panchayati Raj to work properly. The goal of this system cannot be achieved without the support and participation of the local public.

17. Panchayati Raj in India represents –

- (a) Decentralisation of powers
- (b) Participation of the people
- (c) Community development
- (d) All of these

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

The Panchayati Raj System is established for full advancement and development of villagers. Panchayati Raj represents decentralization of democratic power, Community development, and participation of people.

18. Which State does not have Panchayat system?

- (a) Nagaland
- (b) Mizoram
- (c) Meghalaya
- (d) Kerala
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (e)

Article 9 of the Indian Constitution has provisions related to Panchayats from Articles 243 to 243O. As per clause (2) of Article 243 M, the provisions relating to panchayats shall not apply to the hill areas of Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram Manipur where district councils exist. Hence the correct answer to this question is (e) i.e. 'More than one of the above'.

19. Which one of the following is not the characteristic of decentralization?

- (a) Autonomy
- (b) People's participation
- (c) To instill non-confidence among local communities
- (d) To empower local communities
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above.

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Decentralization means delegation of authority to make decisions to the lowest possible organisational hierarchy level. Under decentralization, an organization's central unit distributes functions, responsibility and accountability to regional and local units. Thus, decentralization marks an extension of the process of delegation. Thus, autonomy of regional or local units, People's Participation and to empower local communities is the characteristics of the decentralization, while non-confidence among local communities is not the characteristic of decentralization.

20. Name the Committee which was set up by the NDC in 1957 for the reorganization of CDP and NES, which suggested a three-tier system of rural local government-

- (a) Balwant Rai Mehta Committee
- (b) Ashok Mehta Committee
- (c) Maharashtra Committee on Democratic Decentralisation
- (d) Rural-Urban Relationship Committee

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Community Development Programme (CDP) was started in 1952, and National Extension Scheme (NES) was started in 1953. Balwant Rai Mehta Committee was constituted in 1957 by National Development Council for the reorganization of CDP and NES. This Committee recommended three-tier Local-self Government under Panchayati Raj System.

21. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists :

List - I (Panchayati Raj Committees)	List - II (Years)
A. C.H. Hanumantha Rao	1. 1985
B. G.V.K. Rao	2. 1986
C. Ashok Mehta	3. 1984
D. L.M. Singhvi	4. 1957
E. Balwant Rai Mehta	5. 1978

Codes

(a)	A	B	C	D	E
	4	5	1	3	2
(b)	A	B	C	D	E
	2	4	1	3	5
(c)	A	B	C	D	E
	5	3	2	4	1
(d)	A	B	C	D	E
	3	1	5	2	4

- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above.

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2020

Ans. (d)

Balwant Rai Mehta Committee was constituted in 1957 and recommended a three-tier system of Panchayati Raj. Ashok Mehta Committee was constituted in 1977 and submitted its report in 1978. Mehta committee recommended to replace three-tier system by two-tier system. In 1985 G. V. K. Rao Committee was constituted and it recommended

for improvement in representative character of Panchayat. L.M. Singhvi Committee was constituted in 1986, which recommended local self-government and allocation of more financial resources to village Panchayats. In 1984 Hanumantha Rao Committee was constituted and it recommended for decentralization of functions, powers and finance, setting up of district planning bodies and district planning cells.

22. The Chairman of the Committee set up for the recommendation of Panchayati Raj in India was –

- (a) Balwant Rai Mehta (b) B.R. Ambedkar
(c) Justice Krishna Ayer (d) Jagjivan Ram

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The correct match of List-I with List-II is as follows :

List-I Committees	List-II Year
P.K. Thungan	1988
Ashok Mehta	1977
Balwant Rai Mehta	1957
L.M. Singhvi	1986

23. The committee on whose recommendation, the ‘Panchayati Raj System’ was introduced in the Country, was headed by –

- (a) Jivraj Mehta (b) Balwant Rai Mehta
(c) Shrimannarayan (d) Jagjivan Ram

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. The Panchayati Raj System was first started in India in the State of Rajasthan and

- (a) Haryana (b) Gujarat
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Andhra Pradesh

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Rajasthan is the first State to establish Panchayati Raj system on 2 October, 1959 in Nagaur district while Andhra Pradesh is the second State to establish Panchayati Raj System.

25. The Decentralization System was recommended by -

- (a) C. Rajagopalachari (b) J.B. Kripalani
(c) Balwant Rai Mehta (d) Ashok Mehta

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Balwant Rai Mehta recommended in 1957 about the three-tier democratic Panchayati Raj System to be set up at the village, block and district level.

26. Ashok Mehta Committee recommended –

- (a) Three-tier Government of Panchayati Raj
(b) Two-tier Government of Panchayati Raj
(c) Single-tier Government of Panchayati Raj
(d) Multiple-tier Government of Panchayati Raj

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Ashok Mehta committee was constituted in 1977, which submitted its report in August 1978. The committee in its report had recommended for ‘two tier’ system in place of ‘three tier’ system. The two-tier system or model was - Zila Parishad at the district level and Mandal Panchayat at the Mandal level which consisted of a group of villages covering a population of 15000 to 20000.

27. Which one of the following Committees/Commissions recommended the creation of Nyaya Panchayats?

- (a) Balwant Rai Mehta Committee
(b) Ashok Mehta Committee
(c) G.V.K. Rao Committee
(d) Sarkaria Commission
(e) None of the above / more than one of the above

63rd B. P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

Ashok Mehta Committee recommended the Creation of Nyaya Panchayats. The Committee recommended that Nyaya Panchayats should be kept as separate bodies and should not be mixed with the people elected for the development of Panchayats. The Committee was in favour of a combination of a qualified Judge to preside over a bench of separately elected Nyaya Panchayats. The elected Nyaya Panchayats will not be entitled to seek re-election, they should serve in an area other than that from which they have been elected.

28. Which Constitutional Amendment granted Constitutional Status to Panchayati Raj Institutions?

- (a) 73rd Amendment
(b) 71st Amendment
(c) 74th Amendment
(d) None of these

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Panchayat Raj System was given a Constitutional Status by 73rd Amendment by inserting Part IX and 11th Schedule to the Constitution. Seventy-third Amendment, 1992 came into force on April, 1993.

29. Which Article gives the list of 29 functions to be performed by the Panchayati Raj Institutions?

- (a) Article 243(H) (b) Article 243(E)
- (c) Article 243(F) (d) Article 243(G)
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

According to Article 243(G) subject to the provisions of this constitution, the Legislature of a state may, by law, endow the Panchayats with such powers and authority as may be necessary to enable them to function as an institution of self-government and such law may contain provisions for the devolution of powers and responsibilities upon Panchayat at the appropriate level, subject to such conditions as may be specified therein, with respect to-

- (a) The preparation of plans for economic development and social justice;
- (b) The implementation of schemes for economic development and social justice as may be entrusted to them including those in relation to the matters listed in the Eleventh Schedule.

30. Which State Governments have provided 50 percent reservation for women in local bodies up to 2010?

- (a) Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan
- (b) Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh
- (c) Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Kerala
- (d) Bihar, Himachal Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (*)

In 2011, when the question was asked, 50 percent seats were reserved for women in Panchayats in the State of Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, and Himachal Pradesh. At present, 50% seats in Panchayats for women are reserved in Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Maharashtra, Odisha, Rajasthan, Tripura, Bihar, Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh, Assam, Gujarat, Karnataka, Sikkim, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, West Bengal, Punjab and Himachal Pradesh.

31. 50% reservation for women in Panchayati Raj Institutions is legalized in certain States such as:

- I. Bihar II. Uttarakhand**

III. Madhya Pradesh

IV. Himachal Pradesh

- (a) Only III (b) Only II and III
- (c) II, III and IV (d) I, II, III and IV
- (e) None of the above / more than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

32. The Three-tier system of Panchayati Raj consists of-

- (a) Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Block Samiti
- (b) Gram Panchayat, Block Samiti, Zila Parishad
- (c) Block Samiti, Zila Parishad, Panchayat Samiti
- (d) Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Zila Parishad

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

The Three-tier Panchayati Raj System consists of Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti (Block Panchayat) and Zila Parishad.

33. A Panchayat Samiti at the block level in India is only a/an

- (a) Advisory Body
- (b) Consultative Committee
- (c) Coordinating and Supervisory Authority
- (d) Administrative Authority
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

The Panchayat Samiti at block level is an administrative body. The functions of Panchayat Samiti relate both to co-ordination and execution. Zila Parishad is a Supervisory and co-ordinating body.

34. Which is not among the powers of Panchayati Raj Institutions in India?

- (a) Implementation of Land Reforms
- (b) Judicial Review
- (c) Implementation of Poverty Alleviation Programmes
- (d) None of these

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Judicial Review is not the power of Panchayati Raj Institution. It is a power of Judiciary. The legislative and executive actions are subject to review by the Supreme Court of India in accordance with the Principle of Judicial review.

35. A Panchayat Samiti at the block level is –

- (a) An advisory body

- (b) An administrative authority
- (c) An advisory committee
- (d) A supervisory authority

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Panchayat Samiti is the local Government body at the Block level. The Panchayat Samiti is a link between the Gram Panchayats and Zila Panchayat. It works as an administrative authority. The Panchayat Samiti collects all the prospective plans prepared at Gram Panchayat level and processes them for funding and implementation by evaluating them.

36. Who amongst the following is a land record officer?

- (a) Patwari
- (b) Lambardar
- (c) Zamindar
- (d) Zaildar
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Land Record officer is Patwari at sub-division or Tehsil level. His job encompasses visiting agricultural lands and maintaining a record of ownership and tilling.

37. What is the objective of Community Development Programmes?

- (a) Providing educational facilities
- (b) Improving standards of living
- (c) Political training
- (d) Helping villages in planning
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

Objectives of Community Development Programme are :

- (i) To assist each village in having effective Panchayats cooperatives and schools;
- (ii) Through these village institutions, plan and carry out integrated multi-phased family, village, Block and District.
- (a) Increasing agricultural Production.
- (b) Improving existing village crafts and industries and organising new ones.
- (c) Providing minimum essential health services and improving health practices.
- (d) Providing required educational facilities for children and an adult education programme.
- (e) Providing recreational facilities and programmes.
- (f) Improving housing and family living conditions, and
- (g) Providing programmes for village women and youth.

More than one of the given option is correct. So, the correct answer is (e).

38. At what level does a Panchayat Samiti operate a Panchayati Raj structure?

- (a) Block-level body
- (b) District level
- (c) Gram Panchayat level
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

The correct answer is Block-level body. It is important to mention here that the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act provides for three-tier local self-govt. at the village (gram panchayat), block(panchayat samiti) and district (zila parishad) level. Gram Panchayat at the village level. Block Panchayat or Panchayat Samiti at the intermediate level i.e. the block level. Zilla Panchayat at the district level. Significantly, Panchayat samiti is a rural local government (panchayat) body at the intermediate tehsil level in India.

39. Consider the following statements :

In the post-73rd Amendment era, there has to be decentralization of

1. decision-making powers
2. system as a whole
3. judicial powers
4. administrative powers

Which of the above statements are correct?

- (a) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 4 only
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

On 24 April 1993, the Constitution (73rd Amendment) Act became effective. It is worth mentioning that it was passed in 1992. The Act gave state governments the authority to take the required actions to formalize gram panchayats and enable them to function as self-governing entities.

The 73rd Amendment Act was introduced by the central government of India in 1992 to solve these problems and enhance local self-government. The law was approved by both chambers and went into effect on April 24th, 1993. Part IX: The Panchayats is a new chapter that was added to the Constitution as a result of this Act.